

**Lenovo C200 All-in-One**

Lenovo's C200 features the NVIDIA Ion 2 GPU, an 18.5-inch screen, with an aspect ratio of 16:9, a 160 GB HDD, and capable of 1080p playback

USB SSD drive launched

Buffalo's SHD-LVS-BK USB SSD drive is powered over USB 2.0, has a 64 GB storage capacity, and has probably started a segment for external SSDs

Desk Invaders



Desktop PCs are here to stay no matter how portable computing gets. We sample some desktops across form factors this month

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Personal computing may have become portable with the unprecedented growth of notebooks, netbooks and smartphones, off late. But when one needs more processing power, or comfort within your home – nothing beats a desktop.

Desktops are varied beasts. The reason for the varied form factors that we see nowadays is the need to address various usage scenarios. Most desktop PCs still follow the cabinet monitor setup, but all-in-ones come with just a monitor, keyboard and mouse for the ultimate space-saving design. Net-tops on the other hand come in a very compact form factor. Based on Intel Atom processors and motherboards with a mini ITX form factor, these devices are meant for users who are looking at basic computing with decent internet experience. We got around eight PCs in all

for this month's test, covering all the form factors. We got four desktop PCs from Acer, one from HP, one all-in-one from Lenovo, a nettop from ZOTAC and an Apple iMac. Sadly, our test coincided with year-ending and accounts closing for most companies, meaning the de facto product line refresh was underway, which is the reason for this rather paltry figure. We have not declared any winners, but look forward to

perhaps revisiting this category later in the year.

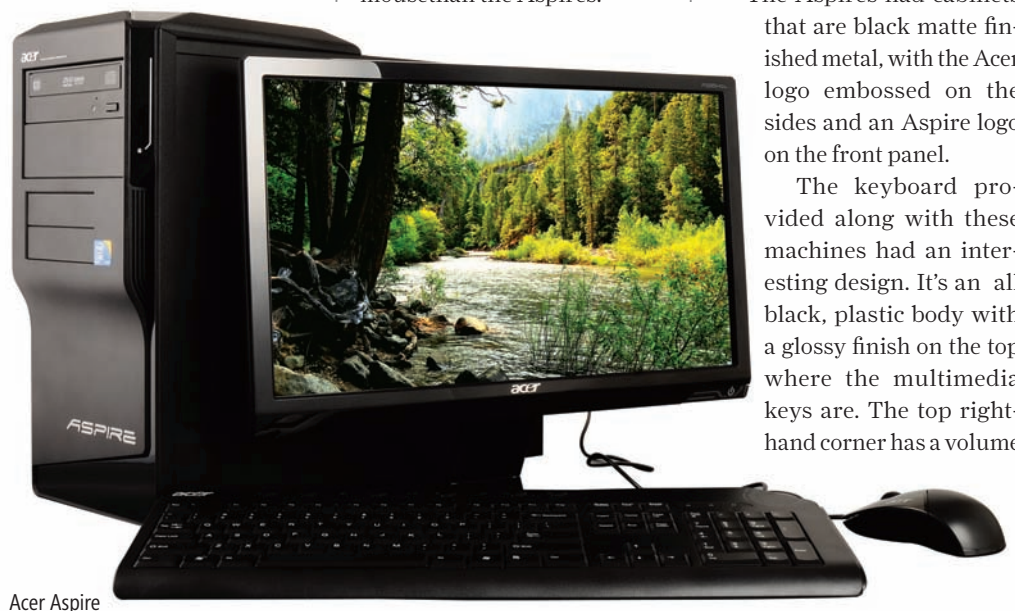
Acer Desktops

We got four Acer machines of which three were from the Aspire series and one was an Acer eMachine. Except for the different processors, all three Aspires were pretty much the same configurations – motherboard, chipset, etc. The Acer eMachine comes with a different keyboard and mouse than the Aspires.

Acer's eMachine 3540 is a low-end PC, marketed by Acer. This PC is meant for those who want a system with average computing power, and will only play the occasional entry-level games. The cabinet is very ordinary, featuring two USB slots, a FireWire port and audio jacks on the front panel. On the rear, you'll find outdated looking connectors, such as serial, parallel and VGA ports, four USB ports, three line audio jacks and a LAN port. The eMachine's PS/2 keyboard is very basic, and doesn't have enough space to rest your palms. Typing on this is not that great. The keyboard's made of strong plastic, and is very light. The optical mouse also has a PS/2 connection.

The Aspires had cabinets that are black matte finished metal, with the Acer logo embossed on the sides and an Aspire logo on the front panel.

The keyboard provided along with these machines had an interesting design. It's an all black, plastic body with a glossy finish on the top where the multimedia keys are. The top right-hand corner has a volume



Acer Aspire